DEBAJYOTI CHAKRABORTY



Ilish, Quite Delish

USHA BISHAYEE, *51*
SUPRABHA BISHAYEE, *28*
OLDAYS KITCHEN
MOHANPUR **WEST BENGAL**

3.2 MILLION subscribers
532,000 followers

The Bishayee family ran a sweetmeat shop, which took a hit during the pandemic. Financial struggles mounted, with a home loan weighing heaviest. In 2021, the mother-son duo Usha and Suprabha tried launching a YouTube channel. It failed. "But we couldn't give up," says Suprabha, who has studied hotel management. Next time, they staked it all—selling their house to clear the loan and using the rest to buy an iPhone 14. "It was a leap of faith," says Usha.

Oldays Kitchen began as a humble venture—a mother in her old-world kitchen, cooking traditional Bengali dishes. By the third video, Suprabha had an idea: food-based rhymes. That formula—a short, funny rhyme (*chhora*) at the outset, related to the recipe of the day, cooked in a rustic oven—struck a chord.